

PROMPT ENGINEERING

Interview Practice Questions

40 questions • scenario challenges • practical task • answer framework

“Do not memorise only definitions - explain the idea, formula, example and use case.”

BEGINNER

SCENARIO-BASED

ADVANCED

Basic Interview Questions

**INTERVIEW
GOAL**

Build a clear foundation before discussing individual techniques.

1

What is prompt engineering?

2

Why is prompt engineering important in Generative AI?

3

What are the essential components of a good prompt?

4

What is the difference between a prompt and an instruction?

5

How does a clear prompt improve an AI-generated response?

CORE FORMULA

ROLE + CONTEXT + TASK + INSTRUCTIONS + CONSTRAINTS + OUTPUT
FORMAT

Prompting-Technique Questions

INTERVIEW GOAL	Explain each technique using a definition, formula and real-time example.
6	What is zero-shot prompting? Give a real-time example.
7	How is one-shot prompting different from zero-shot prompting?
8	What is few-shot prompting, and when should it be used?
9	Explain role-based prompting with an interview example.
10	What information should be included in context-based prompting?
11	What is instruction-based prompting?
12	How does constraint-based prompting control AI output?
13	What is negative prompting? Give an example.
14	Why is output-format prompting important?
15	Explain iterative prompting with a real-time scenario.
QUICK MEMORY	Zero: no example • One: one example • Few: several examples • Role: perspective • Context: background • Instruction: steps • Constraint: limits • Negative: exclusions • Format: structure • Iterative: refine

Comparison Questions

**INTERVIEW
GOAL**

Focus on the exact difference between closely related techniques.

16

What is the difference between one-shot and few-shot prompting?

17

Differentiate role-based and context-based prompting.

18

What is the difference between constraints and negative instructions?

19

Compare instruction-based and output-format prompting.

20

When would you prefer iterative prompting over a single detailed prompt?

ANSWER TIP

State the difference first, then compare the formula, finally give one situation where each technique is preferred.

Scenario-Based Questions

INTERVIEW GOAL	Design complete prompts, not only theoretical definitions.
21	A student enters the prompt 'Explain Java.' How would you improve it?
22	Write a prompt asking AI to generate a professional leave email.
23	Create a few-shot prompt to classify customer feedback as Positive, Negative or Neutral.
24	Write a role-based prompt for conducting a Java mock interview.
25	Create a prompt to explain artificial intelligence to a 10-year-old without technical terms.
26	Write a constraint-based prompt for a LinkedIn post below 100 words with exactly five hashtags.
27	Create a prompt that returns employee information only in JSON format.
28	Write a context-based prompt for creating a five-day Java training plan for fresh graduates.
29	Create a negative prompt for a family-friendly Goa travel plan.
30	Demonstrate iterative prompting while creating a professional resume summary.
PRACTICAL TIP	After writing each prompt, identify the technique and explain which words in your prompt demonstrate it.

Advanced Questions

INTERVIEW GOAL	Show judgement about quality, safety, security and reliability.
31	What should you do when AI produces an irrelevant response?
32	How can prompt engineering help reduce hallucinations?
33	How do temperature and prompts affect an AI response differently?
34	Why should examples in few-shot prompts be diverse and consistent?
35	What happens when a prompt contains conflicting instructions?
36	How would you evaluate the quality of a prompt?
37	What is prompt injection?
38	How can confidential information be protected while writing prompts?
39	Why should AI-generated answers be verified?
40	Can a well-written prompt guarantee a completely correct response? Why?
PROFESSIONAL NOTE	Strong prompts improve reliability, but they do not replace fact-checking, access controls, privacy rules or human judgement.

Practical Interview Task

The interviewer may ask you to write a complete prompt and then identify every technique used.

PROMPT	Act as a corporate trainer and create a two-day Prompt Engineering workshop for 30 fresh graduates. Include topics, demonstrations, practical exercises and assessments. Use simple English and avoid advanced AI mathematics. Present the plan in a table with the columns Day, Topic, Duration, Activity and Learning Outcome. Keep the response below 400 words.
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Role-based	Act as a corporate trainer
Context-based	30 fresh graduates
Instruction-based	Include topics, demonstrations, exercises and assessments
Constraint-based	Simple English and below 400 words
Negative prompting	Avoid advanced AI mathematics
Output-format	A five-column table

FOLLOW-UP CHALLENGE	How would you improve this prompt if the learners already know AI basics? Add the new context and modify only the affected instructions.
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Quick Answer Formula

Use this four-part framework to give a complete, confident interview answer.

ANSWER FORMULA	DEFINITION + FORMULA + REAL-TIME EXAMPLE + BEST USE CASE
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Model Answer: What is Few-Shot Prompting?

1 • Definition	Few-shot prompting means providing two or more examples before asking AI to complete a similar task.
2 • Formula	MULTIPLE EXAMPLES + NEW INPUT
3 • Example	'Excellent service' → Positive 'Very slow delivery' → Negative 'Delivered on Monday' → Neutral Classify: 'The product is amazing.'
4 • Best use	It is useful for classification, pattern recognition and consistent formatting.

Self-Evaluation Checklist

✓	Did I define the concept in one or two clear sentences?
✓	Did I provide the correct formula?
✓	Is my example realistic and easy to explain?
✓	Did I state when the technique is useful?
✓	Did I compare it with a related technique when relevant?
✓	Did I avoid claiming that prompting guarantees perfect accuracy?

FINAL REMINDER	Understand the concept, practise the formula, create your own example, and explain why your prompt works.
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Prepare well. Answer clearly. Prompt confidently.